

Video Editing on GNU/Linux

It's EASY
with Kdenlive



Getting started with video editing could be easy with this non-linear video editor called Kdenlive. Here's how.

I wrote a quickie on Kdenlive last time and wanted to do a more thorough job this month because this is one killer video editor. If you like to make movies and show them to your friends, or even need software for a presentation, Kdenlive is your candidate. If you want to create something that looks professional, I can tell you that while it may not stand as tall as Final Cut Pro, Kdenlive comes quite close to Sony Vegas Pro or Adobe Premiere.

It doesn't matter if you have a Web cam, a mobile phone camera or a high-definition camera: Kdenlive is ready with all the punches. The software supports so many formats that it's not possible for me to give the list without missing out something (for the full list, visit kdenlive.org/about-kdenlive/audio-and-video-formats).

Window shopping

Once you install Kdenlive, the rest is as easy as a walk in the park. In Figure 1, you can see multiple panes. The first window is the project tree that shows you the clips/images/audio files you are using in this project. You can just browse for the files here and bring them to the timeline, or a simple drag-and-drop will work too.

Remember one thing: when you start a project, do not change the location of the files being used. Otherwise, Kdenlive will not be able to find those files, which will result in a broken project. Of course, you can relocate the files using a file browser. But it is better to create folders to save such clips. That way, in case you have to move the whole project from one machine to another, you can do so easily.

Anyway, first, you have to start a new project. You can create one by accessing **File->New**. Make sure you create it in a master folder as it will create numerous sub-folders, which it will use for editing purposes. Now, save the project in the same folder. Remember, this is not the movie, but only the project file that keeps all the references. Here you can select the video profile (Figure 2) and the format in which you want to create and edit your movie. You can also import clips directly from your video camera. However, the moment you unplug the camera, the references to the clips are gone. So, either keep the camera attached or save those clips locally, beforehand.

The second window is the 'Effects window' where you can use plug-ins to add visual effects to your clip. The third is the 'Clip monitor' where you can preview the working